



Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: 02/09/2026	Entry: 1
Description	A small U.S. health care clinic experienced a ransomware security incident on Tuesday at approximately 9:00 a.m. Employees were unable to access critical files, including medical records, which caused business operations to shut down. The attackers gained access through targeted phishing emails containing malicious attachments. When the attachments were downloaded, malware was installed and the attackers deployed ransomware that encrypted critical files. The attackers left a ransom note demanding a large amount of money in exchange for the decryption key. The incident significantly disrupted access to patient data and required the clinic to shut down its computer systems and seek technical assistance.
Tool(s) used	None specified
The 5 W's	The 5 W's

	1. Who caused the incident? An organized group of unethical hackers who targeted the health care clinic using phishing emails. 2. What happened? The attackers sent targeted phishing emails containing malicious attachments. When employees downloaded the attachments, malware was installed. The attackers then deployed ransomware that encrypted critical files, including medical records, and demanded money in exchange for the decryption key. Employees could not access important files and software, causing business operations to shut down. 3. When did the incident occur? The incident occurred on a Tuesday at approximately 9:00 a.m. 4. Where did the incident happen? The incident occurred within the small U.S. health care clinic's computer systems and network. 5. Why did the incident happen? The attackers used targeted phishing emails to gain access to the clinic's network and deploy ransomware. Their goal was to encrypt the organization's critical files and demand a ransom in exchange for the decryption key.
Additional notes	The clinic experienced a major disruption because critical patient data and business files were encrypted. The affected systems were shut down, and the organization had to contact other organizations for technical assistance and to report the incident. Important questions include: How many computers were infected? Was patient information accessed or stolen? Were backups available and unaffected? How did the attackers move through the network after the

	initial infection?
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Tool(s) used	List any cybersecurity tools that were used.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • Who caused the incident? • What happened? • When did the incident occur? • Where did the incident happen? • Why did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

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Need another journal entry template?

If you want to add more journal entries, please copy one of the tables above and paste it into the template to use for future entries.

Reflections/Notes: Record additional notes.
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